

Justices to hear case on protected migrants

Trump administration wants to revoke safe status for many Haitians and Syrians.

By Andrea Castillo

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court will hear arguments this week over whether the Trump administration may revoke temporary protected status for about 350,000 Haitian and 6,100 Syrian immigrants.

TPS allows people who are already in the United States to legally reside and work here if they are unable to safely return to their home country because of a sudden emergency such as war or a natural disaster. The humanitarian program, enacted by Congress in 1990, has since been used by Republican and Democratic administrations alike.

Since President Trump returned to office last year, his administration has terminated such protections for immigrants from 13 countries. Court challenges on behalf of Haitians and Syrians have been consolidated into a single case, *Mullin vs. Doe*, which the justices will hear Wednesday.

The high court's ruling could eventually have sweeping repercussions for all 1.3 million immigrants from the 17 countries that were designated for TPS at the start of this administration. That's because the federal government is arguing that decisions regarding the program are almost entirely immune from review by courts.

"Temporary means temporary and the final word will not be from activist judges legislating from the bench," a Department of Homeland Security spokesperson, who did not provide their name, wrote in response to a request for comment.

Lower courts have repeatedly deemed the administration's actions improper. "We're seeing clear gamesmanship from government to insulate all TPS decision-making from any oversight," said Emi MacLean, a senior staff attorney at the American Civil Liberties Union of Northern California, who is counsel in the case for Syrians and in other cases challenging five of the terminations. "They've created a farce of a process to justify the ends that they sought, which was to strip humanitarian protections from over a million people."

In the Trump administration's appeal, Solicitor Gen. D. John Sauer argued that Congress gave the Homeland Security secretary the power to grant or end the temporary protected status for troubled countries and barred judges from intervening.

He pointed to a provision that says: "There is no judicial review of any determination [See *Immigrants*, A5]



MANUEL BALCE CENETA Associated Press



CARLIN STIEHL For The Times

ACTING ATTY. GEN. Todd Blanche, top, announces charges against Cole Tomas Allen, who bought a shotgun at Turner's Outdoorsman in Torrance, above.

Torrance man charged with trying to kill Trump

Suspect planned to shoot through gala, officials say

By Ben Wieder, Kevin Rector and Michael Wilner

WASHINGTON — Federal prosecutors on Monday charged 31-year-old Torrance resident Cole Tomas Allen with attempting to assassinate President Trump after rushing past security at the White House Correspondents' Assn. dinner in Washington on Saturday.

The charge, announced during a brief arraignment hearing in federal court in Washington and detailed in a subsequent charging document, carries a potential sentence of life in prison

for the Caltech graduate and high school tutor.

Prosecutors also charged Allen with transporting firearms across state lines while traveling by train from California to Washington and with discharging a firearm during the incident at the Washington Hilton, where officials said a federal agent was shot in his ballistic vest.

In the charging document, prosecutors also detailed an email Allen allegedly sent to family members just as he was preparing to

breach the event perimeter, in which he allegedly wrote that top Trump administration officials were his target but that he was willing to "go through" others at the event to reach them.

Allen was instead taken down by agents shortly after rushing past them and before descending stairs and entering a ballroom where Trump and other top administration officials were seated. No officials were injured during the incident, [See *Charges*, A7]

Suspect bought guns in South Bay, hot spot for firearms sales

By Connor Sheets

At Turner's Outdoorsman in Torrance, racks of long guns line the back wall under taxidermied deer and antelope heads. On Sunday afternoon, shoppers browsed for fishing poles and sifted through a wide array of camouflage hunting gear.

It could have been a scene straight out of a gun store in rural Utah or Alabama, but instead it was in a nondescript strip mall on a busy

stretch of Hawthorne Boulevard, steps away from a nail salon and a Cold Stone Creamery ice cream shop.

For those who perceive Los Angeles County as a difficult place to obtain a firearm, due to state and local regulations, it may come as a surprise that the man charged with attempting to assassinate President Trump reportedly purchased his firearms in L.A.'s South Bay.

Cole Tomas Allen, who authorities say rushed a banquet room at the White

House correspondents' dinner on Saturday night, had legally bought a 12-gauge shotgun at the Turner's location in his hometown of Torrance, as well as a semi-automatic pistol at CAP Tactical Firearms in neighboring Lawndale.

The shooting has left the city of Torrance reeling, with neighbors and co-workers voicing astonishment at how a well-regarded tutor with a mechanical engineering degree from Caltech could be accused of such a

[See *Firearms*, A7]

Billionaire tax appears headed toward ballot

Supporters say they gathered more than enough signatures to qualify the measure.

By Seema Mehta

Supporters of a billionaire tax said Monday that they are submitting nearly twice as many signatures as necessary to qualify the controversial proposal for the November ballot.

Advocates say the proposed tax is critical to compensate for federal healthcare funding cuts, approved by President Trump and the Republican-controlled Congress, that will harm millions of the state's most vulnerable residents.

"We are out here today because California's health is at stake. Last year, Trump and Congress kicked 3.4 million Californians off their healthcare and doubled and tripled premiums for everyone else. Hospitals are closing and people will die," said Liz Perlman, the executive director of AFSCME Local 3299, which represents more than 40,000 University of California workers, at a news conference in downtown Los Angeles. "Why? So billionaires can get another tax cut that they don't need. It's immoral and needlessly cruel. And this measure does one

thing, it rights that wrong."

Proponents of the ballot measure began submitting nearly 1.6 million signatures to county election officials at noon Monday. To qualify the proposal for the November ballot, they need to submit the signatures of nearly 875,000 registered voters by June 24.

Opponents of the measure said the proposal would destroy California's economy and budget, while doing nothing to address the state's underlying financial issues.

"This wealth tax would have a devastating impact on our economy, state budget, and the cost of living for all Californians," said Rob Lapsley, president of the bipartisan California Business Roundtable. "The measure doesn't do anything to reduce the state's \$35-billion-plus budget deficit and does nothing to address the decade of overspending that led to the structural deficit. In fact, because the state relies so heavily on high-income-earner tax revenue, this measure could lead to reduced budget revenue in the long term as highly mobile wealthy individuals leave the state to avoid this new tax."

Supporters of the "Transparency Act," a so-called poison pill proposed [See *Billionaire*, A6]

One plaintiff, 1,800 ADA violation suits

He, others say they're advocating for the disabled. Store owners see it as a money grab.

By Rebecca Ellis

Anthony Bouyer has been on a suing spree around the San Fernando Valley.

On Sept. 24, the 55-year-old internet marketer confronted a counter at a hole-in-the-wall Mexican spot that was difficult to reach over in his wheelchair. He sued the business for violating the Americans With Disabilities Act. In Los Angeles County, it was at least his 231st case of the year.

At the convenience store next door, he found a produce scale out of arm's

length. He sued it too.

Two shops over at another Mexican spot, he noticed a cracked parking lot and cumbersome door hardware. Owner Elia Barraza was served a day before her 53rd birthday.

"This person is just suing anyone," said her still-fuming son, Steven Barraza. "It's just for nitpicking things."

Lawsuits under the Americans With Disabilities Act — a federal civil rights law widely known as the ADA — have long flourished in California, where a unique state law enables payouts over various infractions. The money, advocates say, is one of the few surefire ways to get businesses to make their stores accessible and abide by the landmark law that has transformed the lives of disabled Americans. [See *Lawsuits*, A6]



DMITRI LOVETSKY Pool Photo

ALLIES MEET

Iran's Abbas Araghchi and Vladimir Putin head to talks in St. Petersburg, Russia. Tehran's negotiations with the U.S. have stalled. **WORLD, A2**

Candidates take the stage again

Times columnists discuss what to watch for during the second California governor debate. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 74/54. **B6**

Markets **A11**
Opinion Voices **A12**

Trump's call for Kimmel's firing

They blame the ABC host and others for a rise in political violence. **BUSINESS, A9**

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Not a mini-volcano; just spontaneous combustion

By Grace Toohey

On Thursday afternoon, fire crews in Santa Barbara rushed to a hillside where flames and smoke seemed to erupt out of an opening in the cliffs.

The so-called Hope Ranch Volcano — as it's known by locals — had again ignited, and it took crews hours to put out unwieldy flames and hot spots.

But experts say the site's name doesn't accurately explain why the area routinely flares up — at least, geologically speaking.

No, it's not a volcano, and



Santa Barbara City Fire Department

THE SO-CALLED Hope Ranch Volcano along the Santa Barbara coast ignited once again last week.

while firefighters often refer to the spot as a "natural solfatara," geologists say that isn't quite right either.

"It's spontaneous combustion," said James Boles, a professor emeritus with UC Santa Barbara's Earth Science Department.

When the earth layers of the cliffside move, oxygen can interact with unstable compounds in the rocks — including iron sulfides — producing a lot of heat in the process. That heat can build so quickly and so intensely under the right circumstances that organic materials in the area spontaneously ignite. [See *Flare-up*, A6]